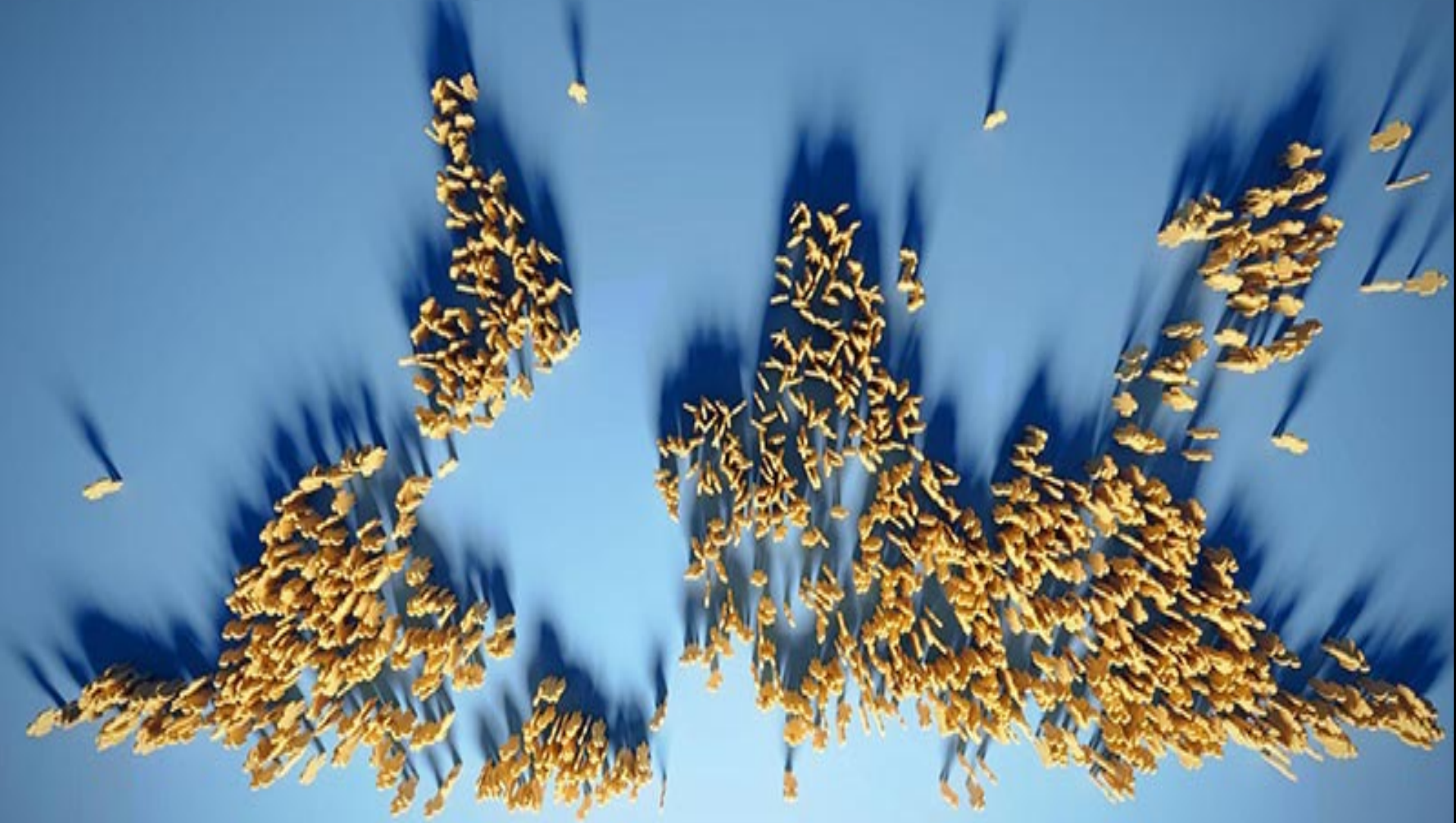


ENG103 Research Writing Techniques

AS2, G3.1-G3.2: Research Objectives & Research Questions, and G4: Research Methods



Session outline

Research Objectives Writing Guide - G3.1

Research Questions Writing Guide - G3.2

Research Methods Writing Guide - G4

Research Objectives Writing Guide - G3.1

A Research Objectives section in your essay functions to:

- concisely explain to the reader what your research intends to achieve
- explains the scope of your research i.e. the remit of your research
- disaggregates your research goal; i.e., separates the different components that constitute your research goal.

Research Objectives Writing Guide - G3.1

Your Research Objectives Paragraph should include the following:

- a reiteration of the importance of your research topic
- an illustration of the need for your research
- an explanation of the major objectives of your research, which focus on different areas related to your research topic

Research Objectives Writing Guide - G3.1

An example of a Research Objectives paragraph written in accordance with the guide:

The topic of online learning has an important relevance beyond the Covid-19 pandemic. Moreover, one of the most important groups to be affected by its continued use are students. However, even though studies have collected data on how this mode of learning affects students' performance, it is unclear what their attitudes are to the virtual classroom. In this context, there are three main interconnected objectives of this research: the first is to ascertain student attitudes regarding online learning as an effective mode of study. The second is to investigate if students believe that online learning improves their grades. The third is to collect data on whether students believe online learning improves their social interactions.

Research Questions Writing Guide - G3.2

Research Questions function to:

- highlight the subject related problems your research attempts to resolve
- highlight the gaps in current research that you attempt to fill
- make the goals of your research more tangible

Research Questions Writing Guide - G3.2

To write your Research Questions:

- firstly, identify questions that if answered help to achieve your research goals.
- while formulating your questions, consider their possible answers (it is important to ask questions with possible answers that people are interested in)
- present your draft questions to your peers to ascertain if they are questions that are inspiring and worth answering

Research Questions Writing Guide - G3.2

An example of Research Questions written in accordance with the guide:

The main questions this research endeavours to answer are as follows:

1. What do students believe regarding the effectiveness of online learning?
2. What do students believe regarding the impact of online learning on their grades?
3. What do students believe regarding the impact of online learning on their interactions with other students and their social life.

Research Methods Writing Guide - G4

An overview of the different research methods:

A quantitative research method collects structured data that is numerical in nature. For example, the use of a structured survey to undertake a study to determine the percentage of minority groups that are racially assaulted in the UK would be an example of quantitative research.

A qualitative research method focuses more on individual subjective accounts and aim to collect data often missed by Quantitative research methods. For example, the use of unstructured interviews to undertake a study to determine the long-term effects of racial assaults on victims would be an example of Qualitative research.

A mixed research method combines quantitative and qualitative approaches to produce more robust results. For example, the use of a structured survey as well as unstructured interviews to undertake a study to determine the frequency of racial assaults and their causes would be an example of a mixed research method. The quantitative based survey would inform us of frequency of racial assaults while the qualitative based interviews would tell us about the causes of the assaults.

Research Methods Writing Guide - G4

- A research methods section should concisely explain to the reader the main method you will use to collect data.
- Furthermore, it should also offer a justification of your research method.
- Also, it should provide details about your targeted participants, in the case of surveys, interviews etc, and the relevance of your research method.
- In addition, it should explain the tools (e.g., Google Forms) you will use to undertake your research.

Research Methods Writing Guide - G4

Research Methods Paragraph should include the following:

1. an explanation of the research method you used
2. a justification of the choice of research method
3. an explanation of your questionnaire design and the types of question you will ask, e.g. will you use multiple choice and or the Likert scale
4. an explanation of the sample size and details about your participants (e.g., university students)
5. a description of the methods used to recruit your participants
6. a description of the tools you will use to conduct your online survey (e.g., Google Forms)

Research Methods Writing Guide - G4

An example of Research Methods paragraph written in accordance with the guide:

To achieve the three main objectives of this research, a quantitative research methodology will be used in the form of a cross-sectional survey with forced-choice answers. This approach was most germane to the research objectives because it allows for the collection of structured data from the sample group, which can be used to form assertions about the population. The survey has three sections: 1) questions to determine student attitudes towards the effectiveness of online learning, 2) questions to determine student attitudes regarding the impact of online learning on their grades, 3) questions to ascertain if students believe online learning improves their interactions with other students. Moreover, Likert scale questions were used with the following range of answers: strongly agree, somewhat agree, neutral, somewhat disagree and strongly disagree. Regarding the sample, 35 Bachelor students were recruited from the male campus of Prince Sultan University, which has a total of 3463 students. The students were recruited through promoting the survey on WhatsApp student groups. Furthermore, the survey utilized the Google Forms tool to collect and analyze the data.

References

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Matthews, B. and Ross, L (2010) Research Methods a practical guide for the social sciences. Longman